

Esteban Nunez Perez

701-306-4648 | ENunez@Princeton.edu | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

Princeton University

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering; Minor in Robotics

Expected May 2027

Princeton, NJ

Coursework: Space System Design; Space Flight Dynamics; Rocket & Air Breathing Propulsion; Materials Science

EXPERIENCE

NASA

Launch Vehicle Propulsion Engineering Pathways Intern

June 2026 – Present

Cape Canaveral, FL

- Propulsion engineer supporting commercial operations; conducting post flight data reviews, hardware flight readiness certifications, and supporting on-console launch operations (Space X, Blue Origin, ULA, etc.)
- Planning to sit on console for launch of SpaceX Commercial Resupply Services flight 35

Princeton University – Beeson Group

Research Assistant

June 2025 – Present

Princeton, NJ

- Conducted NASA-funded research on cislunar debris mitigation, developing a policy framework for incentive-based debris reduction and sustainable lunar operations
- Authored a 15-page technical-policy report evaluating governance mechanisms, operator incentives, and service-based mitigation strategies for the cislunar environment
- Invited to present research at the International Astronautical Congress 2026 in Antalya, Turkey

United States Senate

Senate Intern

May – August 2024

Washington D.C.

- Wrote daily briefs compiling legislative updates, stakeholder activity, and national trends to inform strategic decisions
- Aided in state and national stakeholder meetings, supporting priorities of legislative team

Appareo Aviation

Manufacturing Intern

May – August 2023

Fargo, ND

- Assembled avionics and agricultural products, ensuring compliance with design specifications while collaborating with senior engineers to troubleshoot integration issues and optimize the assembly process

PROJECTS

LUREX (Lunar Radiation Environment Explorer)

Propulsion & Launch Vehicle Team Lead

January – May 2026

Princeton, NJ

- Led the propulsion and launch vehicle subsystem (4 students) in designing a SMEX-class lunar satellite mission
- Owned the propulsion system, ΔV budget, and propellant tank sizing that drove system architecture, presented the final design to Princeton University faculty and engineers from John's Hopkins Applied Physics Lab

Search and Rescue Robot

Team Lead

August – December 2025

Princeton, NJ

- Led a team of ten students in designing, fabricating, and testing a ~40lb autonomous search and rescue robot
- Designed the drivetrain and coordinated cross-subsystem integration, culminating in the only fully operational robot in the course

Princeton Rocketry

Airframe Sub-team Member

January 2025 – January 2026

Princeton, NJ

- Owned a fin redesign and strengthening campaign using composite manufacturing techniques for

SKILLS

Software & Programming: Creo Parametric, Siemens NX, ANSYS (FEA & STK), NASA GMAT, MATLAB, Python, Java

Manufacturing: Composites, CNC, 3D-Printing, Metal Machining

Languages: English & Spanish (native); French (limited working proficiency)

CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT

Varsity Football: All conference walk-on kicker; 25+ hours per week

March 2024 – Present

SHARE Peer: Confidential peer resource for those affected by sexual and domestic violence

May 2025 – Present